

FACSIMILIA

The game as it looks today, for designing its visuals. 30 Sep 2026.

A grand strategy game of the ancient world that runs to the present. You rule one realm from 300 BC. History guides everything: the borders, the peoples, the rulers, the wars and the goods all come from the record. A playthrough is meant to last weeks or months.

You play on one large painted map of Europe, North Africa and the Near East. Time runs month by month or year by year. Everything else opens as a panel over the map: your treasury, armies, diplomacy, goods, research and goals. Battles you choose to fight yourself open on a separate battle map.

WHAT THIS BOOKLET HOLDS

- Every screen that exists now, as it looks in the game at 1920×1080.
- What each screen shows, and the parts of it you could redesign.
- The current colors and fonts, and the things that have no look yet.

Everything shown is a working first version, built to work rather than to look good. All of it can be redesigned.



The main screen, Rome at the start (300 BC).

THE LOOK TODAY

The interface is dark bronze panels with gold edges on top of a painted, softly shaded map. The look changes with the ages: when the game reaches each age's date, the colors and fonts switch.

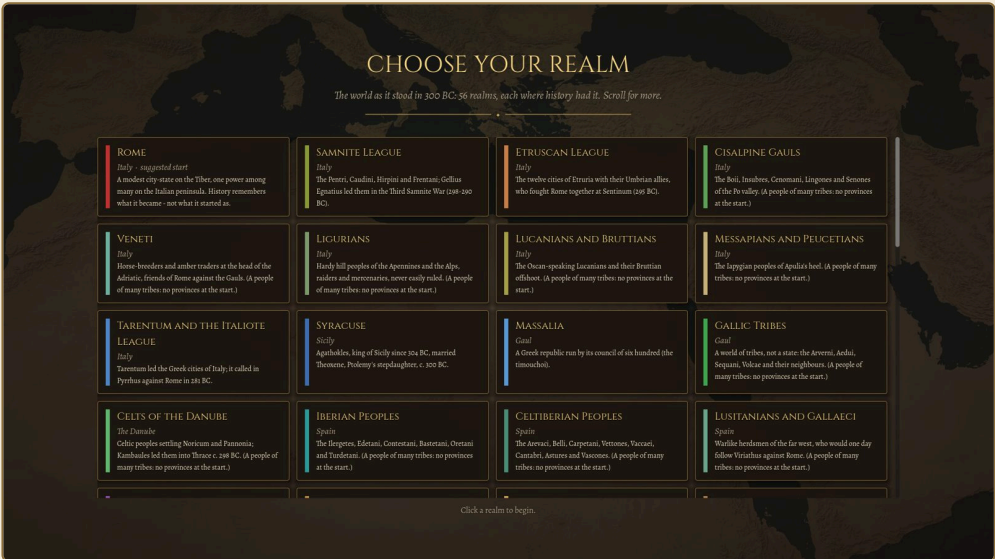
AGE	FROM	ACCENT	PANEL	HEADINGS / TEXT
Antiquity	start			Cinzel / Alegreya
Late Antiquity	AD 250			Cinzel Decorative / Alegreya
The Middle Ages	AD 600			UnifrakturMaguntia / EB Garamond
The Early Modern Age	AD 1450			IM Fell English / EB Garamond
The Modern Age	AD 1800			Josefin Sans / Source Serif

BUILDING BLOCKS USED EVERYWHERE

- **Side panel:** a titled box on the left with a close button (×), holding text, rows and buttons.
- **Card:** a framed row inside a panel (one army, one company, one realm).
- **Buttons:** dark bronze with a gold edge; brighter when hovered, gold when chosen.
- **Icons:** 23 small line icons from game-icons.net (army, coins, laurels, scales, ship...).
- **Tip boxes** ("Tip: Armies ... Got it") and a floating **Needs you** list.



Main menu: the title over a dark map of the ancient world.



Choose your realm: 56 realms as cards, each with a colored edge, its region and a few lines of history.

THE MAIN SCREEN



1 **Top bar:** your realm and its color, the ruler and age, the heir, people, silver, then Armies, Diplomacy, Goods, Research, Score, and the year on the right.

2 **The map:** realms in flat colors over shaded relief, realm names in capitals, towns as stars, rivers and seas. Your armies stand as crossed-swords markers.

3 **Needs you** (right): things waiting for a choice: idle armies, nothing being studied.

4 **Map modes** (bottom right): Inspect, Provinces, Conquest, plus a list of 30 map views, and zoom buttons.

5 **The clock:** play/pause, speed, turn length (1, 5, 10, 25 years) and Advance year.

6 **Chronicle** (bottom left): the story of the game as it happens, line by line.

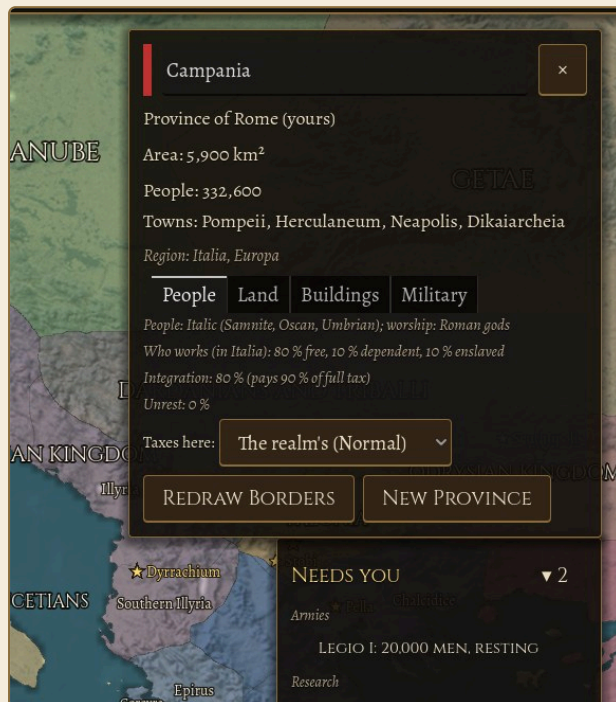
WORTH PROTOTYPING

- The map's painting: borders, the colors of realms, how land and sea meet.
- Realm labels (now straight capitals; you chose curved, fitted to each realm).
- Army markers, town stars, capitals.
- The top bar and the clock.

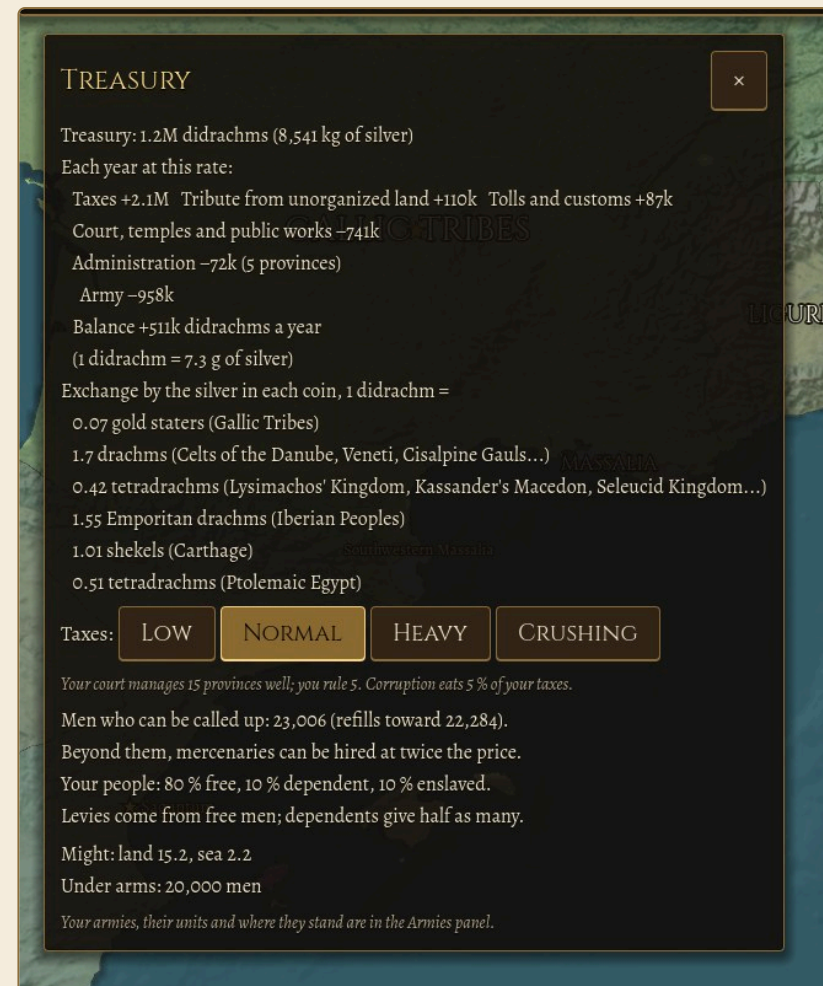
LOOKING AT A PLACE



Hover card: resting the mouse on a province shows its owner, people, loyalty, unrest, garrison and towns.



Province panel (click a province): its owner, area, people and towns, with tabs for People, Land, Buildings and Military, its tax, and buttons to redraw borders.



Realm panel (the treasury): a year's accounts line by line, the coins of other realms, the four tax levels, manpower, and strength.

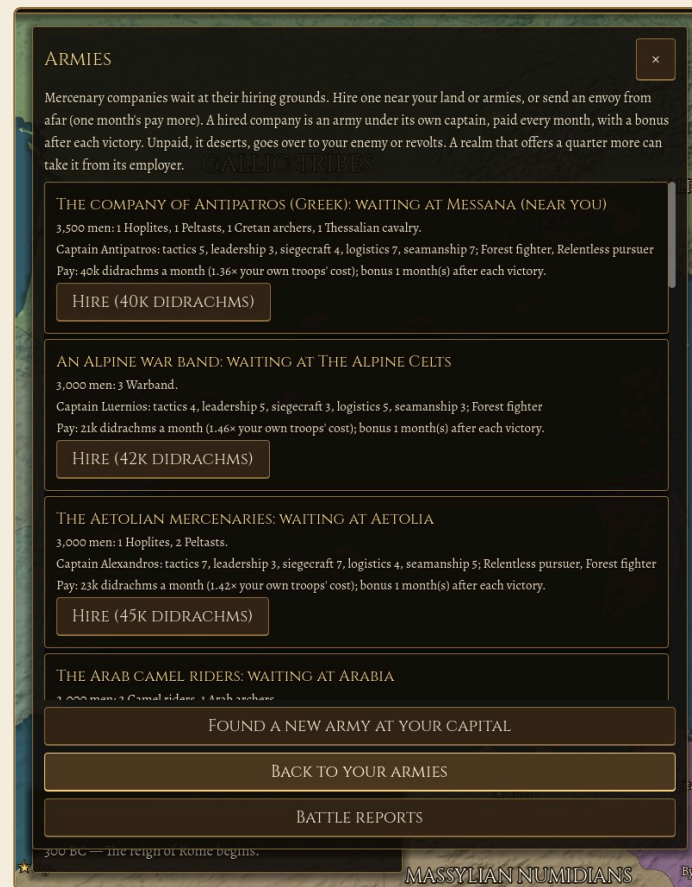
WORTH PROTOTYPING

- A province "card": a picture or emblem, key numbers, tabs.
- The accounts as a readable ledger, perhaps with small bars or coins.
- Hover cards: what shows first, how big.

WAR: ARMIES AND MERCENARIES



Armies: each army as a card: name and place, strength, men, upkeep, general, march and baggage; buttons to choose, move and raise units; the units listed below.



Mercenary companies: each company as a card with its men, captain, pay, and Hire.

WORTH PROTOTYPING

- Army cards: a standard or banner per army (you chose armies can pick their standard), the general's face, unit symbols instead of lines of text.
- Unit symbols: heavy foot, light foot, archers, horse, elephants, ships.
- A roster view: each unit's strength, experience and origin (you chose this; not built yet).
- Mercenary cards: the company's people, the captain, the price.
- Battle reports: the story of a battle, now plain text.

THE BATTLE MAP



When your army meets an enemy, time stops and this opens: a 20 by 12 grid. Pale squares are open ground, green dots woods, tan hills, blue-grey marsh and river. Each block of troops is a small square in its realm's color with a gold strength bar and a blue morale bar.

The panel on the right tells the round, the standing of each side, what the ground does, and holds End turn and Let the general decide. After the battle it tells how the day went.



After the battle.

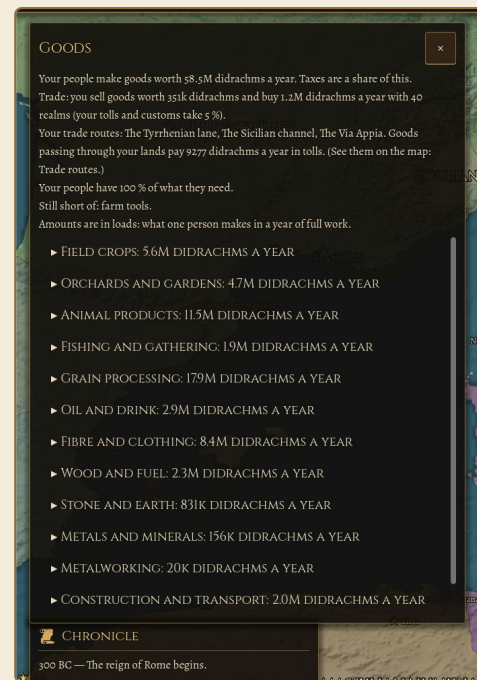
WORTH PROTOTYPING

- The ground: hills, woods, marsh and river as painted terrain rather than squares.
- The troop blocks: a symbol per kind of troop, facing, formation.
- Highlighting: where a block may move, what it may strike.
- The story panel and the end of battle.

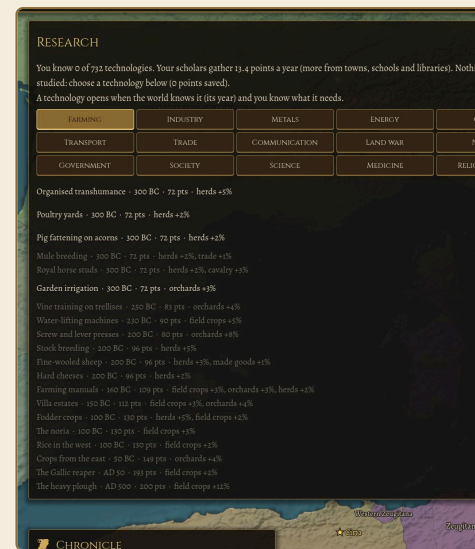
DIPLOMACY, GOODS, RESEARCH, GOALS



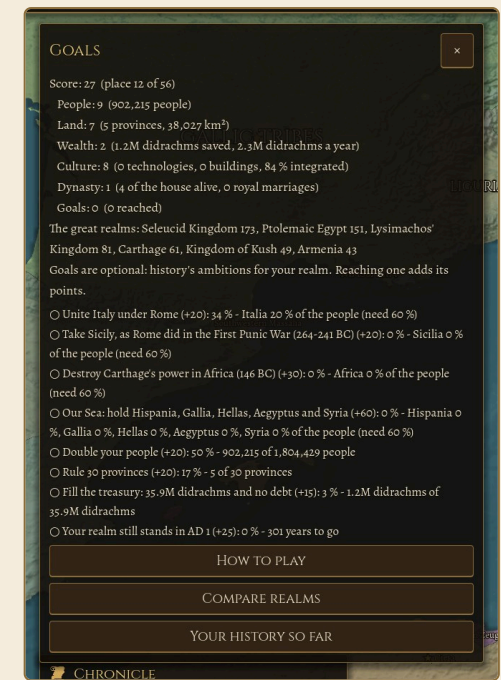
Diplomacy: every realm in a list with its treaties and buttons to declare war, propose alliance, demand submission.



Goods: what your people make and what it is worth, in 13 families.



Research: 732 technologies in tabs by field, what is studied now.



Goals and score: score by category, your realm's historical goals, comparison with others.

WORTH PROTOTYPING

These four are long lists of text today. Each could become its own screen: realms with flags and relations shown as colors; goods with small pictures; research as a tree or a timeline; goals as a record of deeds.

MAP VIEWS



Loyalty: red to green, with a legend top left.



Wealth.



Religion: a color per faith, listed in the legend.



Farmed and grazed land.

All 30 views: Political, Trade routes, Culture, Religion, Loyalty, Wealth, People, Diplomacy, Regions, Terrain, Elevation, Steepness, Ploughable land, Coastal shallows, Climate, Temperature, Winter lows, Summer highs, Rainfall, Rain seasonality, Growing season, Drought risk, Wind, Soil, Fertility, Soil depth, Drainage, Salinity, Erosion risk, Water. **Worth prototyping:** the color scales, the legend, and how a view blends with the painted land.

NO LOOK YET: THINGS TO DESIGN FROM SCRATCH

PLANNED AND DECIDED, NOT YET BUILT

- **Portraits** of rulers, heirs, generals and captains (the court and families exist; they have no faces).
- **The court**: a family tree and council screen.
- **Events** with a picture and a choice (you chose "as an event with a choice", e.g. men of prowess arriving).
- **Army standards** to pick from, per culture.
- **The roster** of an army's units.
- **An outliner**: a collapsible list of your armies, provinces and alerts.
- **The end-of-game history** and the closeness-to-history score.
- **A minimap** in a corner, hideable.
- **Snow and green by month** on the map.

ASKED ON THE LEDGER, WAITING FOR YOUR ANSWER

- "Painted tokens": how the pieces on the battle map should look.
- "Coin portraits": whether faces look like ancient coins.
- "When the globe comes": the whole world map.

ANSWERED, NOT YET BUILT

- Map painting style: both styles, chosen in the settings.
- Realm labels: curved and sized to the realm ("try not to copy the game exactly").

THINGS THAT EXIST BUT ARE PLAIN

- Flags and emblems: realms are only a color now.
- Buildings, goods and units have no pictures.
- Sea battles use the same grid, all water.
- The settings and save screens.

Tell me which part you prototype first and I'll match it in the game.